

Firearms Trace Data: Mississippi - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Mississippi in Calendar Year 2023

5,038

Firearm Types with a Mississippi Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	3,723
Rifles	600
Revolvers	325
Shotguns	320
Machinegun Conversion Devices	27
Machineguns	20
Other*	23

* Other includes Derringers, Receivers/Frames, Silencers, Unknown Types and a Combination.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Mississippi Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	2,276
.40 Cal	576
.22 Cal	366
.380 Cal	299
12GA	217

.45 Cal	200
.38 Cal	153
MULTI	144
7.62mm	126
5.56mm	111

NOTE: There were 511 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 59 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Mississippi Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	1,614
Possession of Weapon	865
Dangerous Drugs	775
Found Firearm	441
Property Crimes	230
Aggravated Assault	178
Homicide	150
Weapon Offense	133
Family Offense	103
Traffic Offense	78

NOTE: There were 471 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Mississippi Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Mississippi	3,230
Tennessee	334
Louisiana	168
Alabama	125
Texas	88
Georgia	74
Florida	48
Arkansas	37
North Carolina	26
Missouri	21
Illinois	17
South Carolina	12
Kentucky	11
Ohio	11
Indiana	10

NOTE: An additional 23 states accounted for 86 other traces. The source state was identified in 4,298 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Mississippi Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	328
3 Months to Under 7 Months	308
7 Months to Under 1 Year	313
1 Year to Under 2 Years	707
2 Years to Under 3 Years	661
3 Years and Over	1,854

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Mississippi Average Time-to-Crime: **5.58 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Mississippi Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	211
18 to 21	512
22 to 24	383
25 to 30	540
31 to 40	661
41 to 50	382
Over 50	271

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Mississippi Average Age of Possessor: **32 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Mississippi Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Southaven	433
Gulfport	356
Jackson	323
Hattiesburg	321
Vicksburg	159
Canton	146
McComb	136
Moss Point	136
Clinton	134
Pascagoula	133

NOTE: There were 202 additional municipalities that accounted for 2,496 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for 265 traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Mississippi. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Mississippi.

- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023.
- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a Mississippi Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Mississippi Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a Mississippi Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Mississippi Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Mississippi Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Mississippi Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024